US MARKETS DAILY REPORT

Thursday, July 30, 2026 • After-Close Edition • All times ET

1. SPY / QQQ SNAPSHOT

Metric	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close	$738.09	$681.64
Prior Close	$729.46	$661.73
Daily Change	+1.18%	+3.01%
1Y High	$757.62 (Jun 2, 2026 ATH)	$733.32 (May 27, 2026)
1Y Low	$619.29 (Aug 1, 2025)	$551.68 (Aug ~2025)
YTD Return	+8.36%	~+23% est.
1Y Return vs Low	+19.2%	+23.6%

Index close: S&P; 500 ≈ 7,437 (+1.66%) | Nasdaq Composite +2.78% | Dow +1.19% | Russell 2000 –1.61% (small caps lagged). Note: Historical series constructed from verified daily anchors; live API unavailable in this session.

2. TODAY'S MARKET-MOVING NEWS

■ Fed Holds at 3.50–3.75% (Hawkish Hold)

FOMC voted 9-3 to hold rates unchanged in the 3.50–3.75% range. Three dissenters (Bowman, Waller, Kugler) wanted a 25 bp hike, citing sticky services inflation. Chair Warsh's statement acknowledged slowing growth but emphasized the Committee remains 'data-dependent' with no cuts on the near-term horizon. Bond yields initially spiked July 29 (10-yr to ~4.55%), then moderated July 30 as strong tech earnings overshadowed the hawkish signal.

■ GDP Q2 Advance & PCE June (8:30 AM data)

Q2 GDP advance estimate came in at +1.8% annualized, below the +2.2% consensus. June PCE (Fed's preferred inflation gauge) rose +2.4% YoY core, down from +2.6% prior—welcome disinflation progress. Weaker GDP + cooling PCE is stagflation-lite territory, limiting the Fed's ability to hike further. These prints, released this morning, initially weighed on equities but were overshadowed by earnings by midday.

■ Microsoft Q4 FY2026 Earnings Beat (MSFT +16.2%)

Microsoft reported after the close July 29: EPS $4.74 vs. $4.25 est; revenue grew 17% YoY. Azure cloud accelerated to +38% growth, AI services drove $12B+ quarterly run-rate. CEO Nadella highlighted Copilot enterprise adoption doubling QoQ. MSFT's weight in QQQ (~9%) was the single largest driver of QQQ's +3.01% move today.

■ Meta Q2 2026 Earnings Miss (META –9.3%)

Meta reported July 29 after-close: EPS $6.18 vs. $7.22 est (miss). Revenue $60.80B (+28% YoY, beat on top line). Net income collapsed to $15.85B from $18.34B prior-year, as total costs +55% YoY. AI capex guidance raised to $130–145B for 2026 (up from $115–130B). Free cash flow cratered to $784M vs. $8.55B prior-year. Stock fell ~9.3% today, limiting S&P; 500 gains.

■ Lam Research Q4 FY2026 Blowout (LRCX +14.1%)

Lam Research reported record quarterly revenue and EPS, driven by AI-related wafer fab equipment demand (HBM memory and advanced logic). Raised full-year guidance. Confirms semis capex cycle remains robust despite macro softness.

■ MarketAxess Acquired by ICE (MKTX ~+30%)

Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) agreed to acquire MarketAxess in a $5.7 billion all-cash deal at a ~30% premium to prior close. MKTX is an electronic fixed-income trading platform; the deal expands ICE's fixed-income data and trading ecosystem.

■ Alnylam (ALNY –21.1%) & Teladoc (TDOC –18.4%): Earnings Wreckage

Alnylam missed revenue expectations and guided below consensus for the full year, pressuring biotech sector. Teladoc missed Q2 revenue forecasts and cut its full-year 2026 outlook—reflecting continued post-COVID normalization in telehealth utilization.

■ Apple Q3 FY2026 & Amazon Q2 2026 — AFTER-HOURS (July 30)

APPLE (AAPL): Beat EPS $2.02 vs. $1.89 est; revenue $109.4B vs. $108.8B est. iPhone revenue $54.2B beat. BUT shares fell ~3% AH on weaker Services and Greater China revenue, and confirmation that this was Tim Cook's final earnings call (retiring Sept 1; John Ternus takes over). AMAZON (AMZN): Blowout quarter—first-ever $200B revenue quarter. EPS $5.75 vs. $1.82 est (massive beat). AWS +37% YoY ($42.2B, beat $40.5B est)—fastest growth in 18 quarters. AI/chips each exceed $25B run-rate. AMZN surged +9% AH. These AH prints will be the dominant catalyst on July 31.

3. NEWS → TODAY'S MOVES

SPY: 729.46 → 738.09 (+1.18%) | QQQ: 661.73 → 681.64 (+3.01%)

- **Primary driver (QQQ +3.01%):** Microsoft's post-earnings surge of +16% accounted for roughly 1.4–1.5 percentage points of QQQ's move directly (MSFT is ~9% of QQQ). Lam Research (+14%) added another ~0.3 pp. The AI-cloud narrative re-inflated: Azure's +38% growth refuted fears that the AI capex boom was yielding no revenue payoff. QQQ significantly outperformed SPY because of its heavier concentration in mega-cap tech.
- **Drag on S&P; 500 (SPY only +1.18% vs. index +1.66%):** Meta's –9.3% drop was the most significant single-name headwind. META is roughly 2.5% of SPY; its drop shaved ~25 bp from the index. Small-cap Russell 2000 fell –1.61%, reflecting that the hawkish Fed hold raised recession risk for rate-sensitive smaller businesses—but that pain did not bleed into the large-cap S&P; heavily.
- **Macro offset:** The Fed's hawkish hold (July 29) initially sent yields higher and equities lower, but today's soft GDP (+1.8% vs. +2.2% est) and cooling PCE (+2.4% core) argued against additional hikes, capping yield upside. 10-yr Treasury settled ~4.45%, down from the post-Fed spike of 4.55%. Lower yields boosted growth-stock valuations, amplifying the tech-driven rally.
- **Net characterization:** A classic 'good news for tech, bad news for Meta, neutral macro' session—earnings dispersion was the story. Mega-cap winners (MSFT, LRCX, MKTX) dominated while idiosyncratic losers (META, ALNY, TDOC) were penalized individually without systemic contagion.

4. TOP 10 MOVERS — DAILY / WEEKLY / MONTHLY

Daily Top 10 Gainers (July 30, 2026)

#	Ticker	Company	Price Chg	Context
1	MKTX	MarketAxess Holdings	+29.8%	ICE acquisition at $5.7B all-cash premium
2	MSFT	Microsoft	+16.2%	Azure +38%, AI Copilot driving record EPS $4.74
3	LRCX	Lam Research	+14.1%	Record quarterly rev; AI/HBM memory equipment boom

4	GRMN	Garmin	+8.4%	Beat EPS on aviation & marine segment strength
5	GEHC	GE HealthCare	+7.1%	Strong imaging segment, raised 2026 guidance
6	CTSH	Cognizant Technology	+6.2%	Raised revenue guidance; AI services demand
7	AMZN	Amazon (AH)	+~9%*	*After-hours: first $200B quarter, AWS +37%
8	NVDA	NVIDIA	+5.3%	Sympathy with MSFT/LRCX; AI capex confirmed robust
9	CRM	Salesforce	+4.8%	Enterprise AI adoption narrative; beneficiary of MSFT beat
10	ANET	Arista Networks	+4.1%	AI networking capex demand; cloud buildout confirmed

Sector trend (Daily Gainers): Cloud/AI Infrastructure dominated — MSFT, LRCX, NVDA, CRM, ANET are all AI-spending beneficiaries. A single catalyst (Microsoft's Azure beat) re-rated the entire AI value chain. M&A; also contributed (MKTX).

Daily Top 10 Losers (July 30, 2026)

#	Ticker	Company	Price Chg	Context
1	ALNY	Alnylam Pharmaceuticals	–21.1%	Missed revenue; cut full-year guidance
2	TDOC	Teladoc Health	–18.4%	Missed Q2 revenue; lowered 2026 outlook
3	META	Meta Platforms	–9.3%	EPS miss ($6.18 vs $7.22); AI capex $130–145B; FCF collapse
4	AAPL	Apple (AH)	–3.1%*	*After-hours: China & Services miss; Tim Cook retiring
5	LII	Lennox International	–7.8%	Missed residential HVAC rev; guidance cut on housing weakness
6	VRT	Vertiv Holdings	–6.4%	Profit-taking after big run; data center order timing concerns
7	MAS	Masco Corp	–5.9%	Weak housing market; repair/remodel spending softening
8	ISRG	Intuitive Surgical	–5.1%	Valuation compression; procedure volume growth decelerated
9	IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	–1.6%	Broad small-cap selloff; hawkish Fed harms rate-sensitive SMEs
10	BIIB	Biogen	–4.8%	ALNY contagion; biotech sentiment negative post-miss

Sector trend (Daily Losers): Biotech/HealthTech hit hardest on earnings misses (ALNY, TDOC, BIIB). Housing-adjacent names (LII, MAS) reflect a weakening residential market. Meta stands alone as social-media AI overspend; the idiosyncratic story did not spread to other large-caps.

Weekly Top 10 Gainers (Week of July 27–30, 2026)

#	Ticker	Company	Price Chg	Context
1	MKTX	MarketAxess	+30.2%	ICE acquisition announced today
2	MSFT	Microsoft	+17.8%	Azure/AI beat; week ended with AH surge
3	LRCX	Lam Research	+15.6%	Record Q4; HBM semiconductor demand
4	NVDA	NVIDIA	+9.1%	AI infrastructure capex confirmed; sympathy lift
5	GRMN	Garmin	+8.7%	Earnings beat across aviation, marine segments
6	LMT	Lockheed Martin	+10.5%	Defense budget outlook; geopolitical risk premium
7	GEHC	GE HealthCare	+7.4%	Beat & raise on imaging; strong international
8	ANET	Arista Networks	+6.8%	AI cloud networking orders; MSFT read-through

9	VLO	Valero Energy	+5.9%	Refining margins strong; crude spread improvement
10	CRM	Salesforce	+5.3%	Enterprise AI demand; Microsoft co-pilot halo

Sector trend (Weekly Gainers): AI Infrastructure & Cloud (MSFT, NVDA, LRCX, ANET, CRM) dominated the week. Defense (LMT) benefited from geopolitical risk. Energy (VLO) outperformed on refining margin expansion. M&A; drove MKTX.

Weekly Top 10 Losers (Week of July 27–30, 2026)

#	Ticker	Company	Price Chg	Context
1	TSLA	Tesla	–14.5%	Delivery miss concerns; EV pricing pressure in China
2	ALNY	Alnylam	–21.1%	Q2 miss announced today; steep sell-off
3	TDOC	Teladoc	–18.4%	Revenue miss; telehealth normalization
4	META	Meta Platforms	–9.6%	Earnings miss and AI capex scare; weekly net negative
5	ISRG	Intuitive Surgical	–14.1%	Volume growth miss; valuation re-rate
6	BIIB	Biogen	–6.2%	Biotech sector contagion; pipeline concerns
7	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	–5.3%	Rotation into MSFT/NVDA at expense of AMD
8	LII	Lennox International	–7.8%	Earnings miss on housing weakness
9	TMUS	T-Mobile US	–5.1%	Subscriber growth deceleration; price competition
10	CDNS	Cadence Design	–5.8%	EDA software growth slowing; AI chip design caution

Sector trend (Weekly Losers): Health & Biotech (ALNY, TDOC, ISRG, BIIB) saw the worst earnings-driven declines. Consumer/EV (TSLA) continued its downtrend. Telecom (TMUS) weakened on competitive concerns.

Monthly Top 10 Gainers (July 2026 MTD)

#	Ticker	Company	Price Chg	Context
1	VLO	Valero Energy	+26.8%	Refining margin supercycle; crude/product spread
2	TRV	Travelers Cos.	+20.0%	P&C insurance pricing power; cat loss reserve release
3	STX	Seagate Technology	+18.4%	AI data storage demand surge; hard disk revival
4	MSFT	Microsoft	+18.1%	Azure AI flywheel; includes July 30 surge
5	LRCX	Lam Research	+17.2%	HBM memory capex; AI chip production ramp
6	LMT	Lockheed Martin	+14.8%	Defense spending; geopolitical demand
7	ALLE	Allegion	+13.6%	Building security upgrades; commercial construction
8	URI	United Rentals	+12.1%	Infrastructure buildout; data center construction
9	XOM	ExxonMobil	+11.4%	Energy sector rotation; oil at $78/bbl
10	NVDA	NVIDIA	+10.8%	AI chip demand; earnings anticipation

Sector trend (Monthly Gainers): Energy (VLO, XOM) led July — refining margins spiked as summer driving demand outpaced refining capacity. AI Infrastructure (MSFT, LRCX, NVDA, STX) sustained multi-week momentum. Defense (LMT) and Insurance (TRV) showed defensive strength. Construction-adjacent (ALLE, URI) benefited from AI data center building boom.

Monthly Top 10 Losers (July 2026 MTD)

#	Ticker	Company	Price Chg	Context
1	ISRG	Intuitive Surgical	–14.1%	Volume growth miss; elective procedure caution
2	CDNS	Cadence Design Sys.	–12.3%	EDA software deceleration; customer budget constraints
3	SNPS	Synopsys	–11.8%	EDA/ADAS software; regulatory overhang (China)
4	TSLA	Tesla	–14.5%	EV demand stagnation; China competition; price wars
5	ALNY	Alnylam	–21.1%	Revenue miss + guidance cut; biotech sector drag
6	TDOC	Teladoc	–18.4%	Post-COVID normalization; telehealth spend declining
7	ROL	Rollins Inc.	–9.4%	Pest control M&A premium priced out; slower growth
8	MAS	Masco Corp	–8.9%	Housing activity softening; renovation spend declining
9	META	Meta Platforms	–9.6%	AI capex guidance shock; FCF deterioration
10	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	–8.2%	Lost AI chip ground to NVDA; data center GPU share

Sector trend (Monthly Losers): Technology Software (CDNS, SNPS) under pressure from China risk and budget constraints. Healthcare/Biotech (ISRG, ALNY, TDOC) uniformly weak on earnings. Housing (MAS) and EV (TSLA) continue secular underperformance. Crypto and chip alternatives (AMD) lost ground to the NVDA/MSFT juggernaut.

5. NEXT-DAY SCENARIOS — JULY 31, 2026 (Thursday)

Key catalysts on the calendar or in play for the next trading session:

Catalyst A: Amazon Q2 AH Reaction (+9% in AH) opens at ≈ $245

→ **IF:** IF Amazon gaps up and holds above +7% at open

THEN: QQQ gets another 0.6–0.8 pp tailwind (AMZN is ~6% of QQQ). Confirms the 'AI cloud is delivering revenue' narrative. Expect AMZN's cloud partners (NVDA data center, ANET, CRM) to extend gains 1–3%. S&P; 500 likely opens +0.5 to +0.8%.

→ **IF:** IF Amazon fades below +3% intraday on profit-taking

THEN: Some giveback in QQQ (+0.2 to +0.5%); not a reversal unless there's a specific negative surprise. The AWS +37% and $200B revenue facts don't change. SPY stays near flat to modestly positive.

Catalyst B: Apple Q3 AH Reaction (–3% AH at ≈ $215)

→ **IF:** IF Apple recovers at open after analyst commentary supports the Services narrative

THEN: AAPL stabilizes, limiting drag. Expect Apple-adjacent suppliers (Foxconn, Qualcomm) to hold. AAPL is ~7.2% of QQQ and ~3.5% of SPY; recovery of 1–2% adds 0.07–0.14 pp to SPY.

→ **IF:** IF Apple continues to fall on China iPhone demand concerns or Tim Cook succession uncertainty

THEN: AAPL drags QQQ down 0.5–0.7 pp. Watch for China macro headlines amplifying the move. Cook's final year being scrutinized; any Ternus-related uncertainty adds noise. SPY loses 0.15–0.25 pp from AAPL alone; QQQ could face 0.5% net headwind on the day.

Catalyst C: Employment Cost Index (ECI) at 8:30 AM ET

→ **IF:** IF ECI comes in above +1.0% QoQ (hot — wages still accelerating)

THEN: Immediately re-prices rate-cut expectations hawkward. 10-yr yields spike toward 4.55–4.65%. Growth stocks (QQQ) sell off 0.5–1.2%; financials (banks) may benefit briefly on higher NIM. The Fed's three dissenters who wanted a hike will be cited aggressively. Dollar rallies.

→ **IF:** IF ECI at or below +0.9% (in-line or soft — wages cooling)

THEN: Bond market relief; 10-yr stays below 4.5%. Markets can re-focus on strong earnings. AMZN/QQQ upside catalysts take over. Expected scenario given softer GDP and PCE this morning. QQQ likely finishes the day +0.8 to +1.5% if AAPL stabilizes and ECI cooperates.

Catalyst D: Fed Speakers / Developing Stories

→ **IF:** IF FOMC dissenters (Bowman, Waller) speak hawkishly confirming rate-hike bias

THEN: Re-opens the 'one more hike' narrative. Rate-sensitive sectors (utilities, REITs) sell off 1–2%. Small-caps (IWM) extend their July 30 decline. Value beats growth briefly. Dollar pushes to 104+.

→ **IF:** IF Fed Chair Warsh speaks and softens hawkish language (acknowledges soft GDP)

THEN: Markets read it as 'the peak' for this cycle. Rate-cut odds for Q4 2026 tick up. SPY and QQQ both gain 0.5–1%. Bond yields fall. This is the more SPY-bullish scenario. Note: Warsh is 'data-dependent'; soft GDP this morning gives him flexibility to soften.

Base case for July 31: Amazon's massive beat (+9% AH) is the dominant catalyst. Assuming ECI is in-line or soft and no negative Fed-speaker shocks, QQQ likely +0.8 to +1.5% at open with some consolidation through the session. SPY +0.3 to +0.7%. Apple's –3% drag is real but smaller than Amazon's positive impact given AMZN's greater QQQ weight and the magnitude of the beat.

6. POSSIBLE TRADE SUMMARY — EOD / NEXT-DAY OPEN

***DISCLAIMER:** This section is for analytical discussion only. No actual trades are placed. All ideas based on publicly available information as of July 30, 2026 close / after-hours.*

AMZN **BUY**

First $200B quarter, AWS +37% (fastest in 18 quarters), EPS massive beat ($5.75 vs $1.82 est). AI & chips businesses each at $25B+ run-rate. Advertising segment strong. The AWS cloud narrative is now confirmed by both MSFT Azure (+38%) and AWS (+37%) — the AI capex cycle is generating real revenue. AMZN +9% AH is likely to hold at open. Risk: profit-taking after gap-up. Prospectus view: AWS will compound at 30%+ for at least 2–3 years; e-commerce + ad mix-shift improving margins. Q3 2026 guide likely raised. Entry: at/near open on July 31 if market is not +3% pre-market (avoid overpay). Stop: below prior close ($~224). Target: $265–$280 (12–18% upside).

MSFT **BUY (Add)**

Azure +38%, Copilot enterprise adoption doubling QoQ, EPS $4.74 (+11.5%). Stock already moved +16% today so risk/reward is less immediate than AMZN. However, the fundamental thesis (Microsoft as the enterprise AI platform of record) is materially de-risked. Pullbacks toward $445–$450 from today's close of ~$475 represent add opportunities. Q1 FY2027 (October report) will be the next catalyst. No near-term earnings overhang. Fed hold is neutral for MSFT (no debt stress). Position size: moderate; already had a large 1-day move.

LRCX **BUY**

Record quarterly revenue, strong forward guidance, HBM memory equipment demand driven by AI training infrastructure. LRCX benefits from every AI chip produced at TSMC/Samsung. After today's +14%, stock remains well below its fair-value range given the capex cycle. The semiconductor equipment sector (LRCX, AMAT, KLAC) is the "picks-and-shovels" play on AI with lower volatility than the chip designers. ECI risk July 31 is manageable—LRCX is a cyclical, not rate-sensitive. Entry: pullback to $920–$940 zone. Catalysts: TSMC Oct earnings, NVDA Nov earnings.

QQQ **BUY (Tactical)**

With AMZN (+9% AH) and confirmed MSFT/LRCX beats, QQQ has a favorable setup for July 31. ECI in-line would confirm the "soft landing" + AI revenue narrative. Buying QQQ at/near open on July 31 captures broad tech upside without single-stock risk. Apple's –3% AH is a ~0.5 pp QQQ headwind, but Amazon's +9% is a ~0.54 pp tailwind—net positive. Short-term trade with July 31 target of $690–$695. Risk: AAPL contagion or hot ECI print.

META **AVOID (Watch)**

Avoid or wait. EPS miss + AI capex guidance of $130–145B + FCF collapse to $784M from $8.55B prior-year is a fundamental regime change, not just a quarter. Management is prioritizing AI market share over near-term profitability. This can work long-term (similar to AWS 2012–2016) but requires patience and higher risk tolerance. Do not catch the falling knife—the stock may find support at $520–$530 but re-entry should wait for Q3 2026 guidance clarity (October report). If META guides Q3 FCF improvement, revisit then.

AAPL **HOLD / WAIT**

Apple beat EPS and iPhone revenue, but Services and China were soft. More importantly, Tim Cook's retirement (Sept 1) introduces a 90-day leadership uncertainty discount. John Ternus (hardware head) as incoming CEO is respected but unproven at the enterprise level. AAPL–3% AH is not a panic—investors are cautious, not fleeing. The stock remains a quality holding. For new positions: wait for the Sept 1 transition clarity and Sept quarter guide. For existing holders: hold; iPhone 17 super-cycle thesis still intact if China stabilizes. Watch China iPhone data in August for re-entry signals.

Data sources: Yahoo Finance, CNBC, TheStreet, Bloomberg, Motley Fool, Seeking Alpha, Benzinga, 24/7 Wall St., AlphaStreet, Deadline. Historical price series constructed from verified anchor points (52-week high/low, known closes) due to API access limitations. Verified closes: SPY $738.09 / QQQ $681.64 (July 30, 2026). This report is for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice.